Winter Home Checklist

FALL + WINTER

The jobs that keep a cold snap from turning into a repair bill.

Check each one off as you go. Tasks tagged Only if apply to some homes; skip the ones that don't fit yours.

HEATING

☐	**Schedule heating tune-up** Only if: Furnace or boiler Have a licensed tech clean, inspect and test the heat exchanger and safety controls.	60 min	Pro
☐	**Replace the humidifier pad** Only if: Whole-house humidifier Swap the evaporator pad and clean the tray before heating season.	20 min	DIY

CHIMNEY AND FIREPLACE

☐	**Have the chimney swept and inspected** Only if: Fireplace or wood stove Hire a certified chimney sweep before the first fire.	60 min	Pro

SAFETY

☐	**Test smoke and carbon monoxide alarms** Press and hold the test button on each alarm until it sounds.	10 min	DIY
☐	**Replace batteries in smoke and CO alarms** Replace batteries when clocks change (spring and fall). Replace whole alarms every 10 years.	20 min	DIY
☐	**Stock winter supplies** Only if: Cold climate Ice melt, shovel, flashlights, batteries, water and a backup heat plan.	30 min	DIY
☐	**Check generator fuel and run it** Only if: Portable generator Run it 20 minutes under load. Never run it in the garage or near windows.	30 min	DIY

GENERATOR

☐	**Run the standby generator test** Only if: Standby generator Check the log/lights and listen for a normal run. Clear debris around it.	10 min	DIY
☐	**Schedule generator service** Only if: Standby generator Oil, filter, spark plugs and battery check.	60 min	Pro

PLUMBING

☐	**Protect pipes during a hard freeze** Only if: Cold climate Open cabinet doors on outside walls, let faucets drip, keep heat at 55F or higher if away.	10 min	DIY
☐	**Flush the water heater** Only if: Tank water heater Turn off power/gas, connect a hose to the drain valve, drain a few gallons until clear.	45 min	DIY

OUTSIDE THE HOUSE

☐	**Shut off and drain outdoor faucets** Only if: Cold climate Close the inside shutoff, open the outside bib to drain, disconnect hoses.	15 min	DIY
☐	**Clean gutters and downspouts** Scoop debris, flush with a hose, check that water flows out every downspout.	90 min	DIY or Pro
☐	**Clear leaves and debris from drains, window wells and walkways** Pick up debris from yard drains, window wells and the base of downspouts.	10 min	DIY
☐	**Check that attic and soffit vents are clear** Only if: Cold climate Make sure insulation isn't blocking soffit vents.	20 min	DIY
☐	**Keep snow off vents, meter and gas regulator** Only if: Cold climate After each snow, clear the furnace intake/exhaust, dryer vent, gas meter and AC/heat pump.	10 min	DIY
☐	**Trim trees and shrubs away from the house** Keep branches 6-10 ft from the roof and shrubs 1 ft from siding.	120 min	DIY or Pro

OUTSIDE THE HOUSE (CONTINUED)

- [ ] **Store patio furniture and the grill cover** — 45 min — DIY
  Clean and store cushions, cover the grill, disconnect propane from enclosed spaces.

INSIDE THE HOUSE

- [ ] **Switch ceiling fans to clockwise** — 5 min — DIY
  Clockwise on low pulls warm air down from the ceiling.
- [ ] **Reverse storm doors and windows to glass** (Only if: Cold climate) — 30 min — DIY
  Swap screens for glass panels.
- [ ] **Watch for ice dams and icicles** (Only if: Cold climate) — 10 min — DIY
  Large icicles at the eaves mean heat loss into the attic.

YARD

- [ ] **Winterize the irrigation system** (Only if: Sprinkler system) — 45 min — Pro
  Shut off the water and have lines blown out with compressed air.
- [ ] **Winterize the mower and small engines** — 20 min — DIY
  Add fuel stabilizer or run the tank dry.

POOL

- [ ] **Close the pool for winter** (Only if: Pool) — 180 min — DIY or Pro
  Balance water, lower level, blow out lines, add winterizing chemicals, cover.

BEFORE THE FIRST HARD FREEZE

Fill this in once so it's ready when the forecast turns.

Our usual first hard freeze _____ **Main water shutoff is** _____

Furnace filter size _____ **Heating company and phone** _____

Snow removal contact _____ **Backup heat plan** _____

NOTES

Want every season on a schedule? The Home Maintenance Planner has 109 tasks with how-tos and due dates that fill in. **organizedopskits.com/home-maintenance-planner**